Responsible Administrator: VP Admin/Finance
Responsible Office: Controller's Office
Effective Date: 02/29/2016
Approved by: President
Date of Revision: 05/28/2024

Travel Policy

Policy Statement

This policy outlines procedures for University employees, students, candidates, and others who travel on behalf of the University.

Purpose of Policy

The purpose of this policy it to ensure compliance with all state regulations. Travel funds must be spent in accordance with the rules and regulations presented in the Division of Administration, State of Louisiana, Policy and Procedure Memorandum No. 49, located on the Louisiana Office of State Travel website doa.la.gov/doa/ost/ppm-49-travel-guide/.

Applicability

This policy applies to all persons who travel on behalf of the University.

Policy Procedure

To enhance the professional growth and development of faculty and staff, the University provides travel funds for attending meetings of state, regional, and national organizations. Travel funds are also provided for travel with students and routine travel.

Travel must be approved in advance by the employee's department head, dean, and the appropriate vice presidents, including the Vice President for Administration and Finance. Faculty members must make arrangements for all classes missed.

Claims for Reimbursement

All claims for reimbursement for travel shall be submitted electronically through the University's ERP system and shall include all details required in the system. Claims for reimbursement of travel shall be submitted not later than the fifteenth day of the month following the completion of travel, and any amounts advanced in excess of the expense claim shall be repaid no later than the time the expense claim is submitted.

Required Approval for International Travel

All requests for international travel must be submitted to the University President or his designee for review and approval. International travel is defined as any travel outside the fifty states, the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, and the Virgin Islands.

All requests shall be submitted electronically through the University's ERP system and shall include a detailed account of anticipated expenditures, including room rate/day, meals, car rental and/or local transportation, airfare(s), etc., and the source of funds from which the requested expenses will be paid. In addition, a complete explanation of the purpose of such travel must be provided.

Rates of reimbursement shall be in accordance with the latest approved travel policies and procedures memorandum (PPM 49) issued by the Commissioner of Administration.

Use of University Vehicles

When available and appropriate, State-owned University vehicles are to be used for transportation associated with official University business. The driver must be an employee of the University. Travel must be approved by the department head or budget unit head. Generally, students under the graduate level are not permitted driving privileges of University vehicles. Graduate assistants are granted driving privileges as regular University employees. Funds for travel must be available in the proper budget unit at the time the vehicle request is filed. Complete information about using University vehicles can be obtained at the Physical Plant or from the department head. Employees driving University-owned vehicles or personal vehicles on University business must be certified to drive under the University's Driver Safety Program.

Employees driving a passenger van shall have a current Class D Driver's License. When renting 15 passenger vans, the vehicles **MUST** be transit vans. Other 15 passenger vans may be used for short trips of nor more than 75 miles (one way).

For more information about the program, contact the Office of Environmental Health and Safety at extension 2157 or visit their website at southeastern.edu/admin/safety/safe_driver/index.html.

[End of Policy]